

EVENT REPORT

Agribusiness Summit 2026: From the Ground Up

What happened when young people, farmers, founders and partners met in Accra for SWK Ghana's first in-person Summit.

Saturday, 7 November 2026
The GracedLife Leadership Centre, Ashaley Botwe, Accra

SWK Ghana LBG
swkghana.org

AT A GLANCE

A first in-person Summit, and a full programme.

On Saturday 7 November 2026, SWK Ghana held its first in-person Agribusiness Summit at The GracedLife Leadership Centre in Ashaley Botwe, Accra. The Summit grew out of an online webinar series that has reached more than 300 young people in over nine countries.

Its aim was simple: move young people from an interest in agriculture to a first plan for an agribusiness, in one morning, at no cost to them.

Under the theme **From the Ground Up**, the programme ran from 9:00 AM to 2:00 PM and moved from listening to doing: a panel on building profitable agribusinesses, Spotlight talks from people working in the field, and a hands-on Agribusiness Model Canvas workshop.

This report sets out who came, what happened, what we learned, and what comes next.

138
registrations: 123 online and 15 at the entrance

48
people checked in on the day

12
speakers and facilitators

6
partner organisations

11
volunteers

96%
of attendees aged 18 to 35 (44 of the 46 who gave their age)



The panel session, Beyond the Farm Gate, seen from the audience.

Why we held it

Many of the young people we work with are curious about agriculture but lack three things: people to learn from, a way to test an idea, and a network to start with. The Summit was built around those three gaps. It was free to attend, so that cost kept no one out.

THE DAY

Five hours, from the first welcome to the pledge.



OPENING

A welcome, and words from our host

The day opened with a welcome from SWK Ghana, a recorded goodwill message from **Mr Emmanuel N.K. Nuamah**, Chief Servant of The GracedLife Leadership Centre, and a solidarity message from **Mrs Rachael Danso** on behalf of TGLC, our host and partner.



PANEL

Beyond the Farm Gate: building profitable agribusinesses across the value chain

Moderated by **Elizabeth Kabukie Ocansey**, with **Wilfred Agbi** (Founder and CEO, Calidad Farms Limited), **Tracey Rama Osman Tia** (Agricultural Drone Pilot) and **Richard Yennunam Laarison** (Co-founder, Vehlverde Farms). The panel covered post-harvest loss and logistics, the slow uptake of technology on farms, and the room there is for people who never studied agriculture.



SPOTLIGHT SESSIONS

Lessons from the Field

Short, practical talks from **Samuel Yeboah** (Country Director, Dream Renewables) on solar-powered irrigation, **Tracey Rama Osman Tia** on drones in agriculture, **Mrs Sheila Cornelius** (CEO, Lam Naturals; Managing Director, Cornelius Farms), **Wendy Dumelo** (CEO and Co-Founder, JERO Foods) and **Jonathan Kwarteng** (Founder and CEO, Farmer Hut, Ada). Spoken word artiste **Jovial Hargo Tetteh** performed between sessions.



WORKSHOP

One page, one business: the Agribusiness Model Canvas

Leticia Boateng, Digital Learning Advisor at GIZ's Agri-Business Facility for Africa, introduced the free Agribusiness e-Academy and led the hands-on session. Working in groups, participants mapped an agribusiness on a single page, then shared their Canvases with the room.



CLOSE

"The ground is ready. And so am I."

Before leaving, each participant named one next step for their idea or their business. The day ended with the SWK Community Pledge, said together.

VOICES FROM THE SUMMIT

What the panel told the room.

> **The problem Ghana has is not production. It is post-harvest loss and logistics.**
>
> Let's get involved in agriculture. Identify your niche, map your skillset, find out what you can do, and contribute your skills.

Wilfred Agbi
Founder and CEO, Calidad Farms Limited · Panellist

> **One key challenge I have identified is adoption of technology.**
>
> In as much as drones make the work easier, most indigenous farmers do not accept the technology. They do not believe that drones can distribute fertiliser evenly to their crops.

Tracey Rama Osman Tia
Agricultural Drone Pilot · Panellist

> **Let us change our mindset about agriculture and work together from our various sector backgrounds.**
>
> You can contribute as an IT expert, a banker, a lawyer, an administrator. It doesn't matter if you do not have an agric background.

Richard Yennunam Laarison
Co-founder, Vehlverde Farms · Panellist

"My next step: start making plans towards my business."

Barbara, participant. She left the workshop with a completed Canvas and told us she feels much more confident about starting.



The panel and their moderator after the session.

Speakers and facilitators

- **Mr Emmanuel N.K. Nuamah** · goodwill message
- **Elizabeth Kabukie Ocansey** · panel moderator
- **Tracey Rama Osman Tia** · panellist, Spotlight speaker
- **Jovial Hargo Tetteh** · spoken word
- **Mrs Sheila Cornelius** · Spotlight speaker
- **Jonathan Kwarteng** · Spotlight speaker
- **Mrs Rachael Danso** · solidarity message
- **Wilfred Agbi** · panellist
- **Richard Yennunam Laarison** · panellist
- **Samuel Yeboah** · Spotlight speaker
- **Wendy Dumelo** · Spotlight speaker
- **Leticia Boateng** · e-Academy and Canvas workshop

WHO WAS IN THE ROOM

Young, mixed, and already doing something.

What the 48 people who checked in told us when they registered. They are students, workers and business owners, and more than one in three already runs a venture.

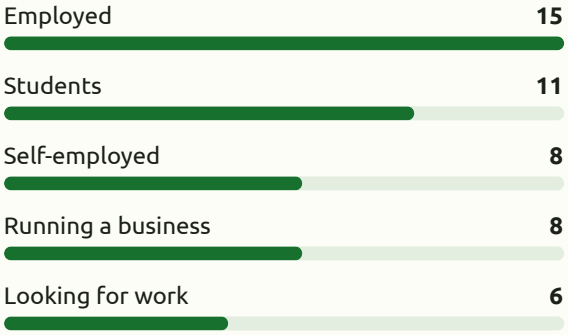
42%
women: 20 women and 28 men checked in

27
median age; 44 of 46 were between 18 and 35

17
attendees already run a venture of their own

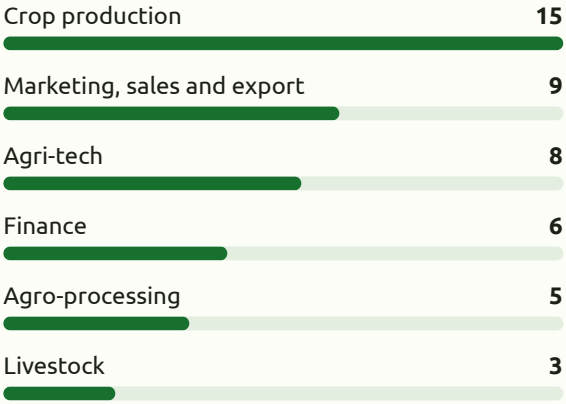
What they do now

48 people



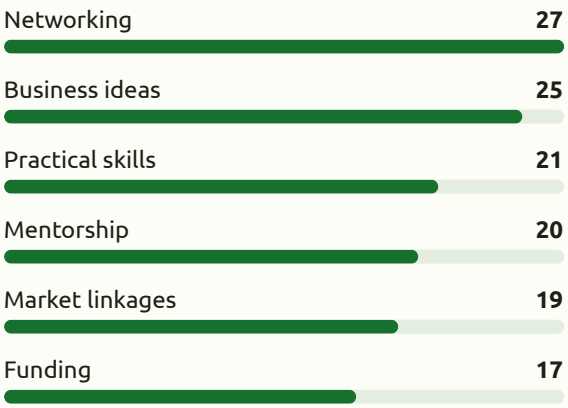
Where their interest lies

Main area of interest, 46 answers



What they came for

People could choose more than one



Everyone who registered

138 registrations

86 men and 52 women registered.

124 of the 136 who gave their age were between 18 and 35.

60 said they already work in agribusiness, and **46** already have a venture.

Of the 48 who checked in, **25** heard about the Summit from a friend or referral and **15** from social media.

Source: the Summit registration form and door check-in. Figures are totals only; no individual's answers are published.

WHAT WE LEARNED

Three things we are taking into the next one.

01

The demand is there

138 people registered for a first in-person Summit, 60 of them already working in agribusiness, and 15 signed up at the door on the day.

02

Registering is not arriving

Of the 123 people who registered online, 33 checked in. Next time we will confirm seats in the final week, share directions earlier, and plan for walk-ins.

03

Guard the clock, and the follow-up

Early feedback rated the content highly and asked us to keep better time. Mentorship was among the things attendees wanted most.

WHAT IS NEXT

The Summit was the start.

Mentorship

Participants can now request mentorship from a Summit speaker, or general guidance in their area. We are putting the requests to our speakers.

swkghana.org/mentorship

Free learning

The Agribusiness e-Academy offers free courses, including the Agribusiness Model Canvas used on the day.

Link at swkghana.org/summit

Community

Opportunities, events and peers in agribusiness are shared in the SWK Ghana WhatsApp community.

Link at swkghana.org/summit

Feedback and certificates

Participant and speaker feedback is still coming in, and certificates are being sent to everyone who took part.

swkghana.org/feedback



The SWK Ghana team and volunteers who ran the day.

OUR PARTNERS

Six organisations made the day possible.

They gave a venue, speakers, learning content and hands. Thank you.

The GracedLife Leadership Centre
Host and venue partner

Agribusiness e-Academy
Agri-Business Facility for Africa, GIZ

Calidad Farms Limited

The Food Discourse

Rotaract Club of Accra Ring Road Central

Dream Renewables

The Summit was free for every young person. Help keep it that way.

SWK Ghana is a youth-focused nonprofit. Gifts and partnerships pay for the venue, materials, and the follow-up that turns one good day into a business that lasts: mentorship, training and community.

Fund a programme. Sponsor the next Summit, a training cohort or the mentorship programme.
Bring your organisation. Speakers, farm visits, learning content, a venue, or opportunities for young people.
Give what you can. Card, Mobile Money or MoMo Pay at swkghana.org/give.

swkghana.org/give

Contact

info@swkghana.org
swkghana.org
@SWK Ghana on Instagram, Facebook, X, LinkedIn and YouTube

About SWK Ghana

SWK Ghana LBG is a youth-focused nonprofit founded in Accra, registered in Ghana as a Private Company Limited by Guarantee under the Companies Act, 2019 (Act 992). We empower and mobilise young people as holistic changemakers.